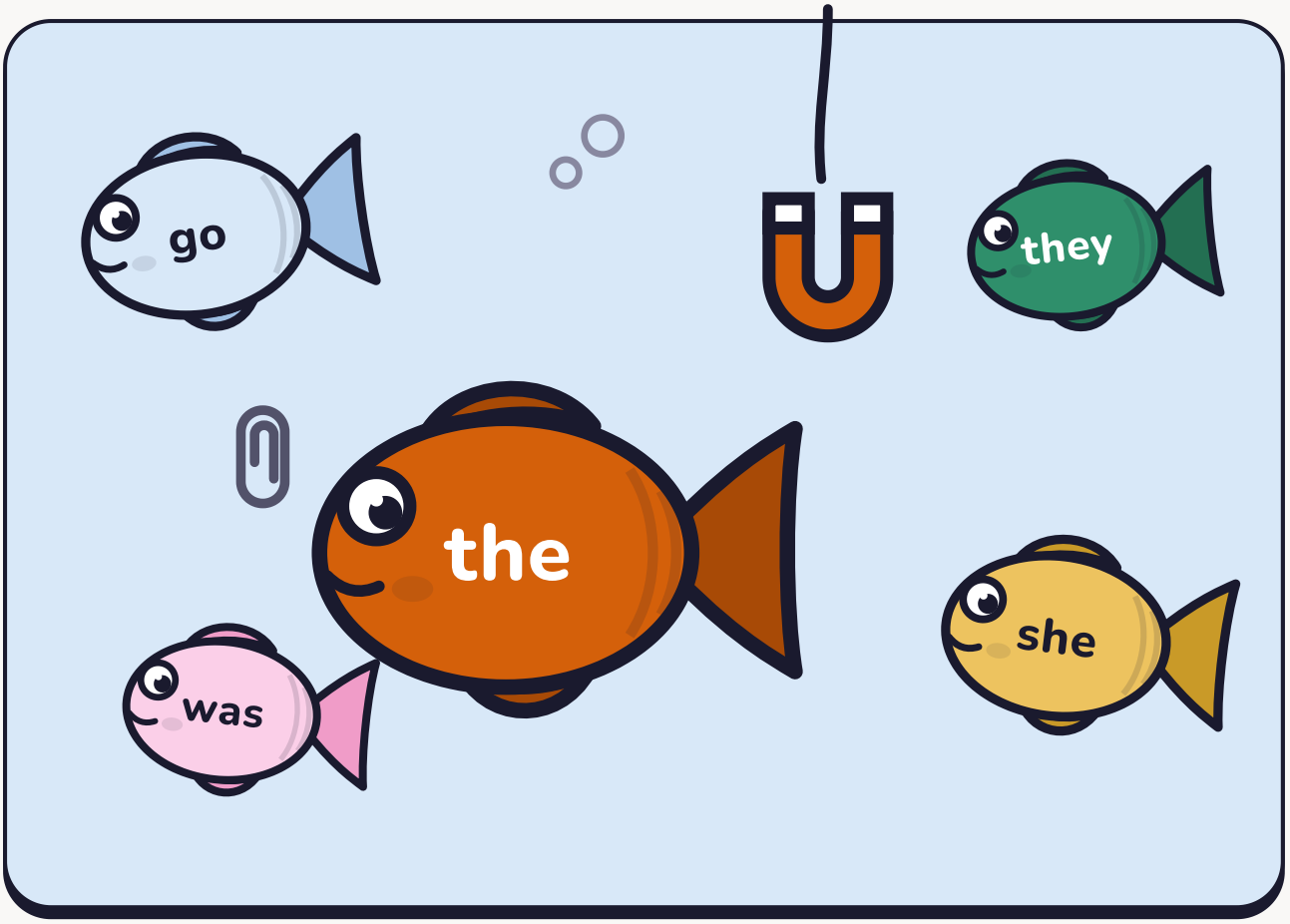
Word Fishing

Print it. Build it. Fish for words.



The 10 minute build

Ages 4 to 7

Phase 2 and Phase 3 tricky words

A paperclip on every fish, a magnet on a string, and suddenly reading practice is the best game in the house.

BUILD ONCE · PLAY FOR YEARS

The 10 minute build

Prep 10 minutes | **Mess level low** | **Grown up on scissors**

Everything here is already in your kitchen drawer. No glue, no paint, no trip to the shops.

You will need	How many	Nice to have
A4 paper or thin card	**6 sheets**	Laminating pouches, so the fish survive years of little hands
Scissors	**1 pair**	Kid safe scissors, so your child can cut the straight bits
Paperclips	**1 per fish, about 60**	Coloured clips that flash like scales in the pond
A magnet	**1, fridge magnet strength**	A magnetic letter borrowed from the fridge works a treat
String or wool	**About 50 cm**	A second string, so two children can fish at once
A wooden spoon or a stick	**1**	A stick from the garden makes it feel like real fishing
Something blue for the pond	**1 towel, scarf or tray**	A big blue scarf makes a properly splashy pond

STEP 1



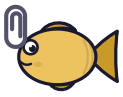
Print.
Pages 4 to 9 on paper or thin card.

STEP 2



Cut.
Cut round each dashed card. Grown up on scissor duty.

STEP 3



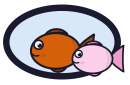
Clip.
Laminate if you can, then slide a paperclip on every fish nose.

STEP 4



Rig the rod.
Tie string to the spoon, tie the magnet to the string.

STEP 5

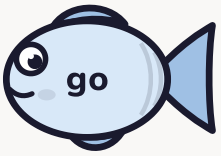


Fill the pond.
Scatter the fish on the blue fabric, clips up. Go fish!

The laminate tip. Laminated fish shrug off juice, bath water and garden ponds, and a dry wipe pen turns the blank fish on page 9 into an endless spelling list. One print, years of fishing.

THREE GAMES · ONE POND

How to play



Start with game one. When the catching gets confident, move up. Five minutes a day beats an hour on Sunday.

1

Catch and say

Dangle the magnet, catch a fish, read the word out loud. Read it right and the fish goes in your bucket. Stuck on one? Say the word together, throw the fish back, and it will swim round again. Most fish when the pond is empty wins.

2

Word match

The grown up calls a word: catch me the word **was**. The child fishes until they land it, checking each catch against the call. This is reading with a mission, and it is sneakily the hardest workout on the page.

3

Beat the clock

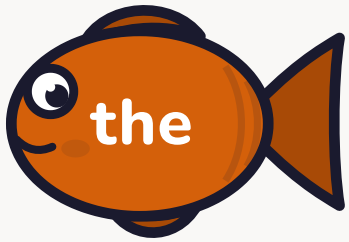
Set a timer for 2 minutes. How many fish can you catch and read before it beeps? Write the score somewhere proud and try to beat it tomorrow. Children race their own best, never each other.

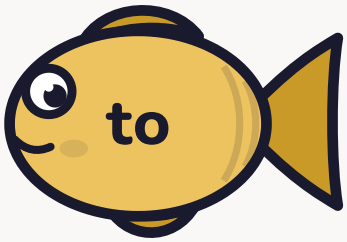
KEEP IT PLAYFUL

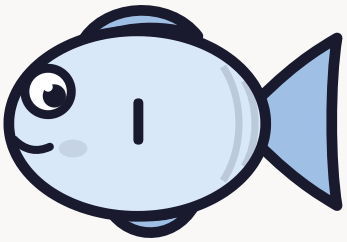
This is a game, never a test. If a word is tricky today, say it cheerfully, let them repeat it, and move on. The magic of Word Fishing is that your child asks to play again, so the practice happens on its own. End every game while it is still fun.

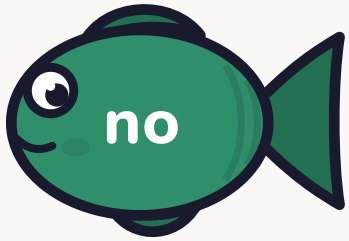
Phase 2 fish, first shoal

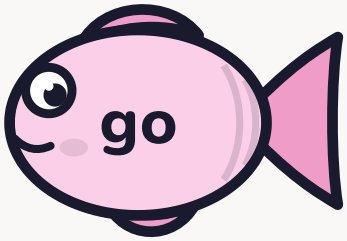
Cut round each dashed card, laminate if you can, and clip a paperclip on every nose.

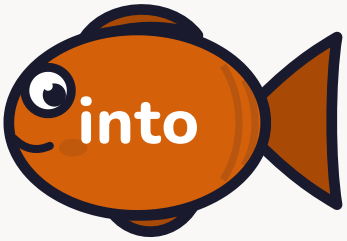


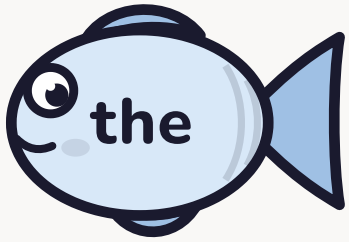


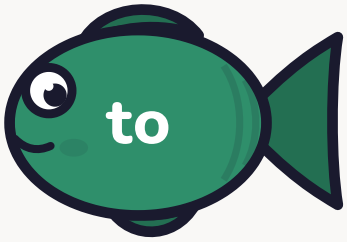


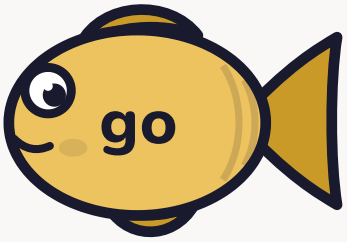






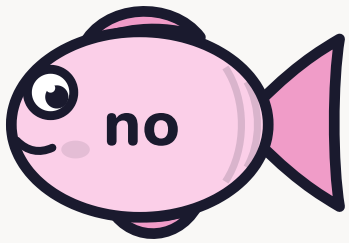


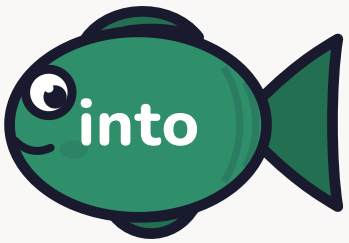


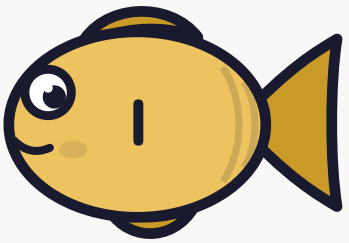


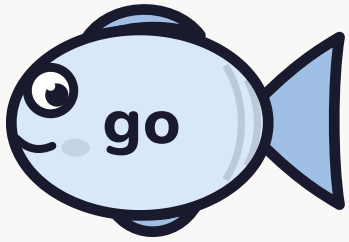
Phase 2 fish, second shoal

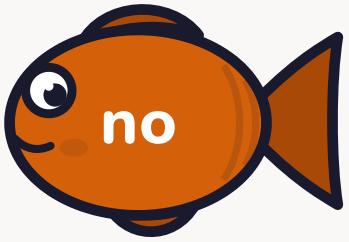
Three of every word across both pages, so the pond stays full even when one fish visits the sofa cushions.

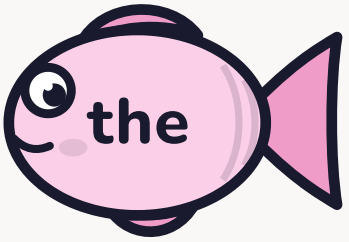


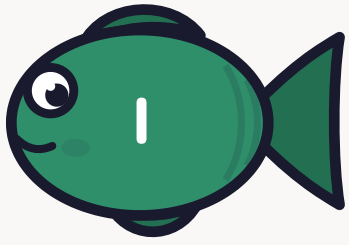


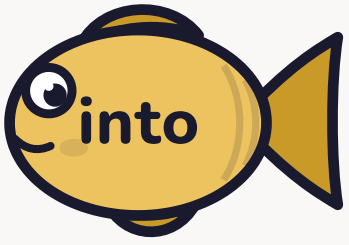


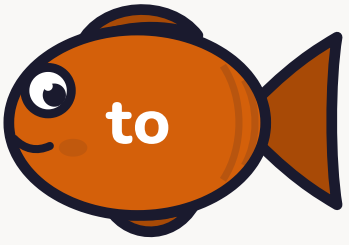






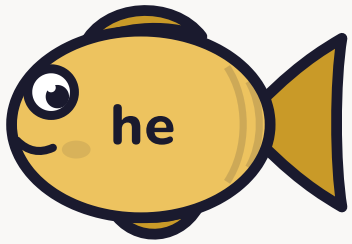


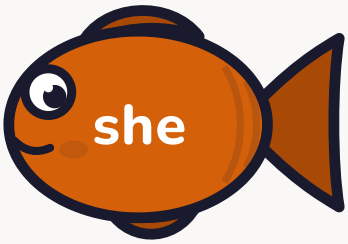


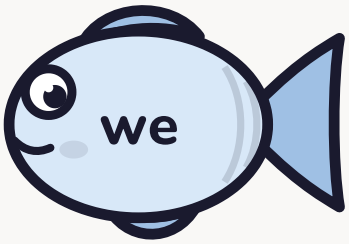


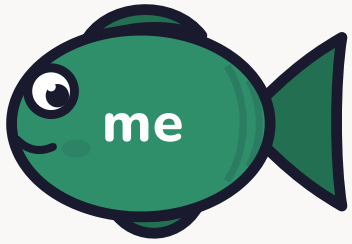
Phase 3 fish, first shoal

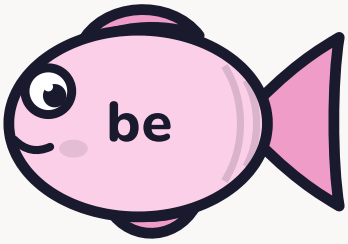
Twelve words, two of each across both pages. Add them to the pond as your child meets them at school.

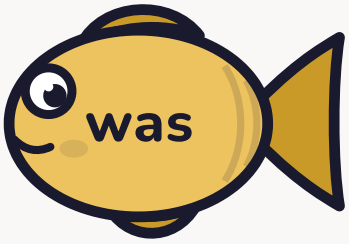


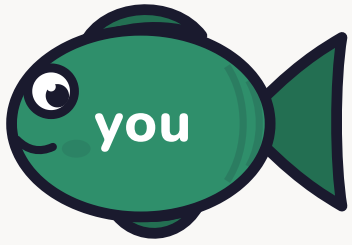


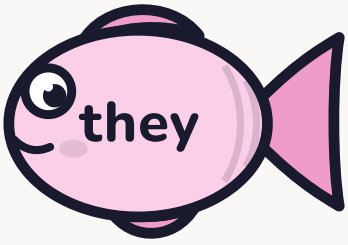


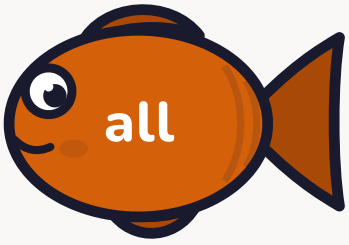


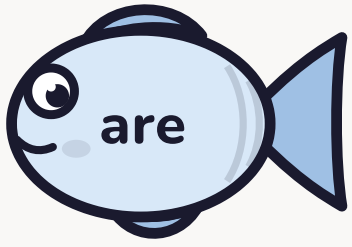


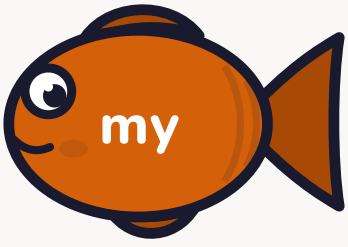


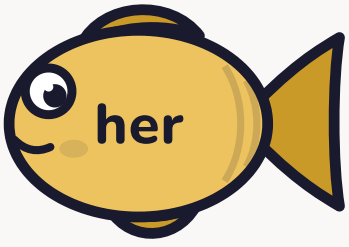










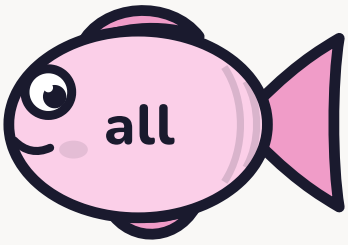


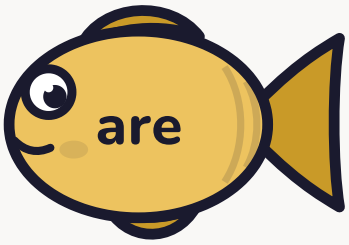
CUT OUT · PHASE 3 TRICKY WORDS

Phase 3 fish, second shoal

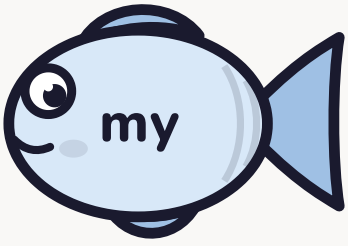
Mix both phases in one pond for a big game, or keep the shoals separate for a gentler one.

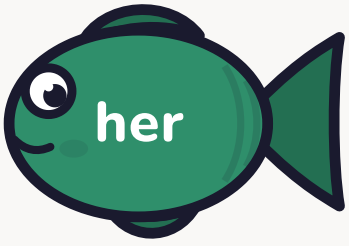


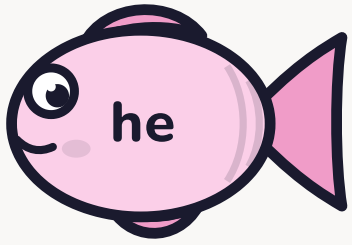


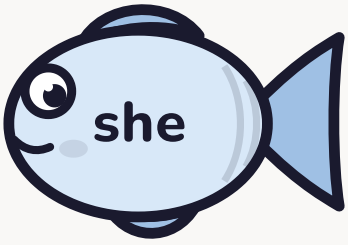


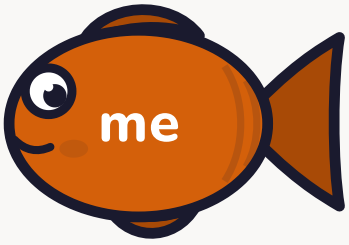


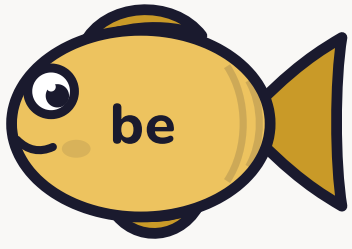


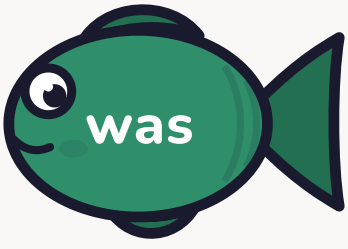


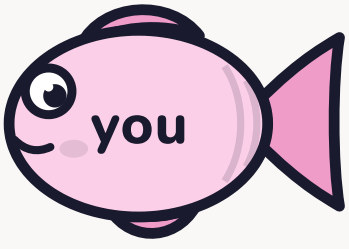








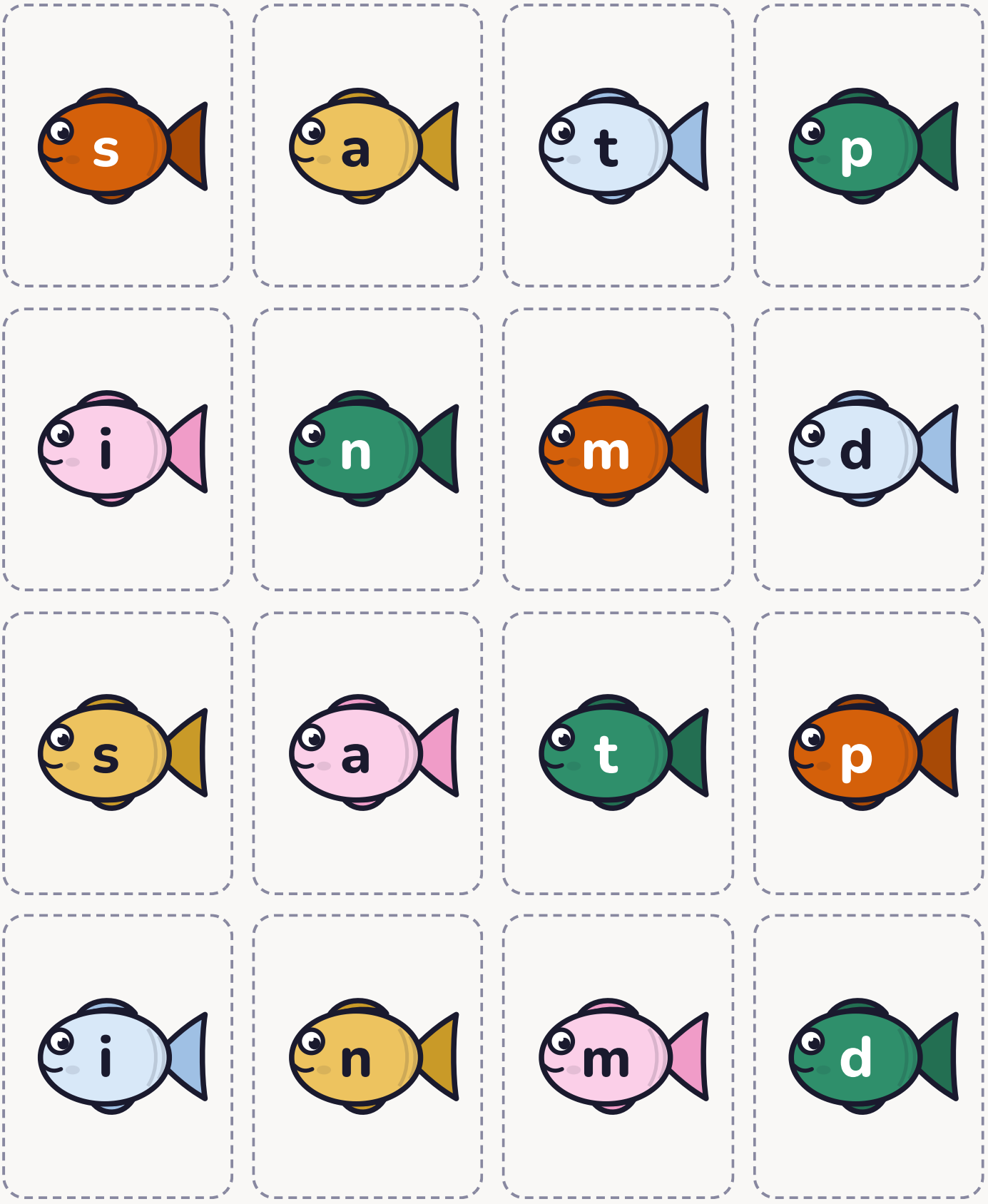




CUT OUT · FIRST LETTERS, S A T P I N M D

Letter fish for younger anglers

The first eight letter sounds children learn, two fish of each. Catch letters, then line them up to build words.

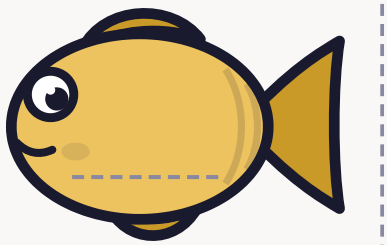
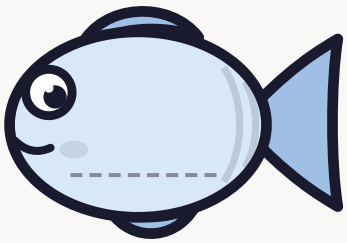
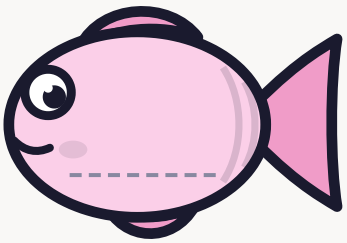
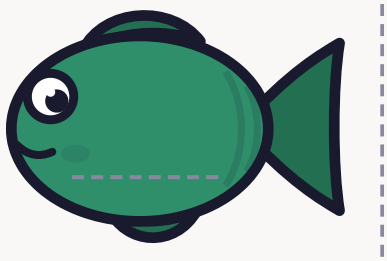
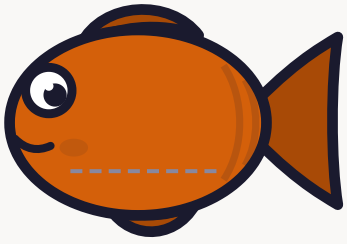
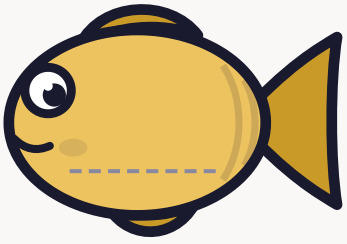
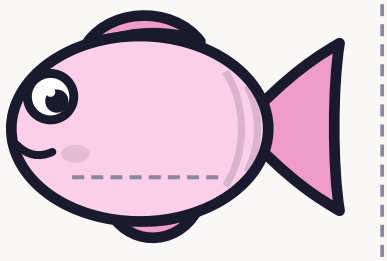
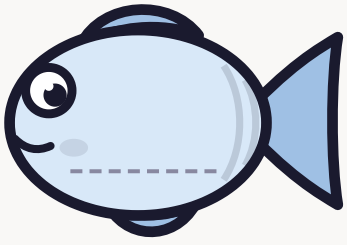
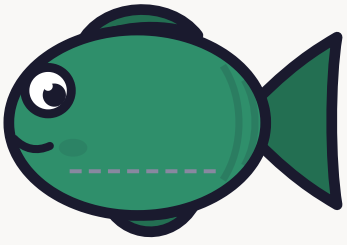


Build a word. Catch three letters and line them up on the pond edge: sat, pin, tap, mat, nap, dip, sad, tin, pat, sit, man, and. Sound each letter, then blend them together like a magic spell.

CUT OUT · YOUR FISH, YOUR WORDS

Blank fish for any word

Write this week's spelling list, names, or new words from school. Laminate and use a dry wipe pen to change them forever.

GUIDED CHILDHOOD

Thank you

You caught the words. Five minutes of fishing a day beats an hour on Sunday, so leave the pond where your child can find it.



A FREE GIFT FOR YOUR FAMILY

As a thank you, the full Guided Childhood Starter Pack is yours free: the star chart, the jobs that earn the stars, and a whole booklet of things to do away from a screen. Pop your email in at the address below and it is yours.

guidedchildhood.com/etsy-bonus

Made by Justin at Guided Childhood, a dad who got tired of the screen time fight. If your kitchen became a fishing lake, a kind review on Etsy helps another family find it.